

GLE

Semester I

General

English

For Internal Circulation Only.

General English

SEMESTER I

3 Credits – 45 hours

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Introduction to English/English Language

Students often wonder - what is the need to study language and literature in their degree courses, as they are already equipped with basic skills that they've learnt through their school year.

Language has existed in various forms around the world for at least somewhere between eighty thousand to a hundred and fifty thousand years, and hereby language I mean speech that is currently still considered valid. Despite your understanding and interest in other subjects, no matter the amount of expertise you attain in your chosen area in terms of interest or profession, at the end of the day; it is your language ability which will determine how well you prove your worth.

The concept is rather simple in order to claim that you've command over any language be it English or otherwise, one needs to be efficient in all four aspects which constitute learning of a language which are Listening, Speaking, Reading and Writing also commonly referred to as LSRW; and that is the goal of having language as a subject in your Bachelor's degree, overall development and command over the ultimate medium of communication.

Apart from learning the basics of communication and a means of expression, the subject of language through the various works of literature taught within it opens the students to learn outside of the boundaries of the chosen field of studies. Literature and language in a way have no boundaries, they can teach you about people and places, about technology and customs, about religion and governments, about psychology and art. It is only through language and the various components involved in learning language does a student have the chance for an overall holistic development.

The textbook for both General and Additional English are compilations, consisting of various pieces of literature such as prose, poetry, short stories, plays, essays alongside indispensable portions of grammar. The accumulation of learning through all these various forms of language learning is used to ensure that a student's LSRW skills are competent. The syllabus is structured in such a manner that they engage in a student's ability to remember, come to a deeper understanding, apply knowledge and concept, analyse texts and evaluate themes and meanings, while creating their own responses.

The Tyger

William Blake

Tyger Tyger, burning bright,
In the forests of the night;
What immortal hand or eye,
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies.
Burnt the fire of thine eyes?
On what wings dare he aspire?
What the hand, dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder, & what art,
Could twist the sinews of thy heart?
And when thy heart began to beat,
What dread hand? & what dread feet?

What the hammer? what the chain,
In what furnace was thy brain?
What the anvil? what dread grasp,
Dare its deadly terrors clasp!

When the stars threw down their spears
And water'd heaven with their tears:
Did he smile his work to see?
Did he who made the Lamb make thee?

Tyger Tyger burning bright,
In the forests of the night:
What immortal hand or eye,
Dare frame thy fearful symmetry?

The Lamb

William Blake

Little Lamb who made thee
Dost thou know who made thee
Gave thee life & bid thee feed.
By the stream & o'er the mead;
Gave thee clothing of delight,
Softest clothing wooly bright;
Gave thee such a tender voice,
Making all the vales rejoice!
Little Lamb who made thee
Dost thou know who made thee

Little Lamb I'll tell thee,
Little Lamb I'll tell thee!
He is called by thy name,
For he calls himself a Lamb:
He is meek & he is mild,
He became a little child:
I a child & thou a lamb,
We are called by his name.
Little Lamb God bless thee.
Little Lamb God bless thee.

ΩΩΩ

The Ransom of Red Chief

O Henry

It looked like a good thing: but wait till I tell you. We were down South, in Alabama—Bill Driscoll and myself—when this kidnapping idea struck us. It was, as Bill afterwards expressed it, “during a moment of temporary mental apparition”; but we didn’t find that out till later.

There was a town down there, as flat as a flannel-cake, and called Summit, of course. It contained inhabitants of as undeleterious and self-satisfied a class of peasantry as ever clustered around a Maypole.

Bill and me had a joint capital of about six hundred dollars, and we needed just two thousand dollars more to pull off a fraudulent town-lot scheme in Western Illinois with. We talked it over on the front steps of the hotel. Philoprogenitiveness, says we, is strong in semi-rural communities; therefore, and for other reasons, a kidnapping project ought to do better there than in the radius of newspapers that send reporters out in plain clothes to stir up talk about such things.

We knew that Summit couldn’t get after us with anything stronger than constables and, maybe, some lackadaisical bloodhounds and a diatribe or two in the Weekly Farmers’ Budget. So, it looked good.

We selected for our victim the only child of a prominent citizen named Ebenezer Dorset. The father was respectable and tight, a mortgage fancier and a stern, upright collection-plate passer and forecloser. The kid was a boy of ten, with bas-relief freckles, and hair the colour of the cover of the magazine you buy at the news-stand when you want to catch a train. Bill and me figured that Ebenezer would melt down for a ransom of two thousand dollars to a cent. But wait till I tell you.

About two miles from Summit was a little mountain, covered with a dense cedar brake. On the rear elevation of this mountain was a cave. There we stored provisions.

One evening after sundown, we drove in a buggy past old Dorset’s house. The kid was in the street, throwing rocks at a kitten on the opposite fence.

“Hey, little boy!” says Bill, “would you like to have a bag of candy and a nice ride?”

The boy catches Bill neatly in the eye with a piece of brick.

“That will cost the old man an extra five hundred dollars,” says Bill, climbing over the wheel.

That boy put up a fight like a welter-weight cinnamon bear; but, at last, we got him down in the bottom of the buggy and drove away. We took him up to the cave, and I hitched the horse in the cedar brake. After dark I drove the buggy to the little village, three miles away, where we had hired it, and walked back to the mountain.

Bill was pasting court-plaster over the scratches and bruises on his features. There was a fire burning behind the big rock at the entrance of the cave, and the boy was watching a pot of boiling coffee, with two buzzard tail-feathers stuck in his red hair. He points a stick at me when I come up, and says:

“Ha! cursed paleface, do you dare to enter the camp of Red Chief, the terror of the plains?”

“He’s all right now,” says Bill, rolling up his trousers and examining some bruises on his shins.

“We’re playing Indian. We’re making Buffalo Bill’s show look like magic-lantern views of Palestine in the town hall. I’m Old Hank, the Trapper, Red Chief’s captive, and I’m to be scalped at daybreak. By Geronimo! that kid can kick hard.”

Yes, sir, that boy seemed to be having the time of his life. The fun of camping out in a cave had made him forget that he was a captive himself. He immediately christened me Snake-eye, the Spy, and announced that, when his braves returned from the warpath, I was to be broiled at the stake at the rising of the sun.

Then we had supper; and he filled his mouth full of bacon and bread and gravy, and began to talk. He made a during-dinner speech something like this:

“I like this fine. I never camped out before; but I had a pet ’possum once, and I was nine last birthday. I hate to go to school. Rats ate up sixteen of Jimmy Talbot’s aunt’s speckled hen’s eggs. Are there any real Indians in these woods? I want some more gravy. Does the trees moving make the wind blow? We had five puppies.

What makes your nose so red, Hank? My father has lots of money. Are the stars hot? I whipped Ed Walker twice, Saturday. I don't like girls. You dassent catch toads unless with a string. Do oxen make any noise? Why are oranges round? Have you got beds to sleep on in this cave? Amos Murray has got six toes. A parrot can talk, but a monkey or a fish can't. How many does it take to make twelve?"

Every few minutes he would remember that he was a pesky redskin, and pick up his stick rifle and tiptoe to the mouth of the cave to rubber for the scouts of the hated pale- face. Now and then he would let out a war-whoop that made Old Hank the Trapper, shiver. That boy had Bill terrorized from the start.

"Red Chief," says I to the kid, "would you like to go home?"

"Aw, what for?" says he. "I don't have any fun at home. I hate to go to school. I like to camp out. You won't take me back home again, Snake-eye, will you?"

"Not right away," says I. "We'll stay here in the cave a while."

"All right!" says he. "That'll be fine. I never had such fun in all my life."

We went to bed about eleven o'clock. We spread down some wide blankets and quilts and put Red Chief between us.

We weren't afraid he'd run away. He kept us awake for three hours, jumping up and reaching for his rifle and screeching: "Hist! pard," in mine and Bill's ears, as the fancied crackle of a twig or the rustle of a leaf revealed to his young imagination the stealthy approach of the outlaw band. At last, I fell into a troubled sleep, and dreamed that I had been kidnapped and chained to a tree by a ferocious pirate with red hair.

Just at daybreak, I was awakened by a series of awful screams from Bill. They weren't yells, or howls, or shouts, or whoops, or yawps, such as you'd expect from a manly set of vocal organs—they were simply indecent, terrifying, humiliating screams, such as women emit when they see ghosts or caterpillars. It's an awful thing to hear a strong, desperate, fat man scream incontinently in a cave at daybreak.

I jumped up to see what the matter was. Red Chief was sit- ting on Bill's chest, with one hand twined in Bill's hair. In the other he had the sharp case-knife we used for slicing bacon; and he was industriously and realistically trying to take

Bill's scalp, according to the sentence that had been pronounced upon him the evening before.

I got the knife away from the kid and made him lie down again. But, from that moment, Bill's spirit was broken. He laid down on his side of the bed, but he never closed an eye again in sleep as long as that boy was with us. I dozed off for a while, but along toward sun-up I remembered that Red Chief had said I was to be burned at the stake at the rising of the sun. I wasn't nervous or afraid; but I sat up and lit my pipe and leaned against a rock.

"What you getting up so soon for, Sam?" asked Bill.

"Me?" says I. "Oh, I got a kind of a pain in my shoulder.

I thought sitting up would rest it."

"You're a liar!" says Bill. "You're afraid. You was to be burned at sunrise, and you was afraid he'd do it. And he would, too, if he could find a match. Ain't it awful, Sam? Do you think anybody will pay out money to get a little imp like that back home?"

"Sure," said I. "A rowdy kid like that is just the kind that parents dote on. Now, you and the Chief get up and cook breakfast, while I go up on the top of this mountain and reconnoitre."

I went up on the peak of the little mountain and ran my eye over the contiguous vicinity. Over toward Summit I expected to see the sturdy yeomanry of the village armed with scythes and pitchforks beating the countryside for the dastardly kidnappers. But what I saw was a peaceful landscape dotted with one man ploughing with a dun mule. Nobody was dragging the creek; no couriers dashed hither and yon, bringing tidings of no news to the distracted parents. There was a sylvan attitude of somnolent sleepiness pervading that section of the external outward surface of Alabama that lay exposed to my view. "Perhaps," says I to myself, "it has not yet been discovered that the wolves have borne away the tender lambkin from the fold. Heaven help the wolves!" says I, and I went down the mountain to breakfast.

When I got to the cave I found Bill backed up against the side of it, breathing hard, and the boy threatening to smash him with a rock half as big as a cocoanut.

“He put a red-hot boiled potato down my back,” explained Bill, “and then mashed it with his foot; and I boxed his ears. Have you got a gun about you, Sam?”

I took the rock away from the boy and kind of patched up the argument. “I’ll fix you,” says the kid to Bill. “No man ever yet struck the Red Chief but what he got paid for it. You better beware!”

After breakfast the kid takes a piece of leather with strings wrapped around it out of his pocket and goes outside the cave unwinding it.

“What’s he up to now?” says Bill, anxiously. “You don’t think he’ll run away, do you, Sam?”

“No fear of it,” says I. “He don’t seem to be much of a home body. But we’ve got to fix up some plan about the ransom. There don’t seem to be much excitement around Summit on account of his disappearance; but maybe they haven’t realized yet that he’s gone. His folks may think he’s spending the night with Aunt Jane or one of the neighbours. Anyhow, he’ll be missed today. Tonight we must get a message to his father demanding the two thousand dollars for his return.” Just then we heard a kind of war-whoop, such as David might have emitted when he knocked out the champion Goliath. It was a sling that Red Chief had pulled out of his pocket, and he was whirling it around his head.

I dodged, and heard a heavy thud and a kind of a sigh from Bill, like a horse gives out when you take his saddle off. A niggerhead rock the size of an egg had caught Bill just behind his left ear. He loosened himself all over and fell in the fire across the frying pan of hot water for washing the dishes. I dragged him out and poured cold water on his head for half an hour.

By and by, Bill sits up and feels behind his ear and says: “Sam, do you know who my favourite Biblical character is?”

“Take it easy,” says I. “You’ll come to your senses presently.”

“King Herod,” says he. “You won’t go away and leave me here alone, will you, Sam?”

I went out and caught that boy and shook him until his freckles rattled.

“If you don’t behave,” says I, “I’ll take you straight home.

Now, are you going to be good, or not?”

“I was only funning,” says he sullenly. “I didn’t mean to hurt Old Hank. But what did he hit me for? I’ll behave, Snake-eye, if you won’t send me home, and if you’ll let me play the Black Scout today.”

“I don’t know the game,” says I. “That’s for you and Mr. Bill to decide. He’s your playmate for the day. I’m going away for a while, on business. Now, you come in and make friends with him and say you are sorry for hurting him, or home you go, at once.”

I made him and Bill shake hands, and then I took Bill aside and told him I was going to Poplar Cove, a little village three miles from the cave, and find out what I could about how the kidnapping had been regarded in Summit. Also, I thought it best to send a peremptory letter to old man Dorset that day, demanding the ransom and dictating how it should be paid. “You know, Sam,” says Bill, “I’ve stood by you without batting an eye in earthquakes, fire and flood—in poker games, dynamite outrages, police raids, train robberies and cyclones. I never lost my nerve yet till we kidnapped that two-legged skyrocket of a kid. He’s got me going. You won’t leave me long with him, will you, Sam?”

“I’ll be back sometime this afternoon,” says I. “You must keep the boy amused and quiet till I return. And now we’ll write the letter to old Dorset.”

Bill and I got paper and pencil and worked on the letter while Red Chief, with a blanket wrapped around him, strutted up and down, guarding the mouth of the cave. Bill begged me tearfully to make the ransom fifteen hundred dollars instead of two thousand. “I ain’t attempting,” says he, “to decry the celebrated moral aspect of parental affection, but we’re dealing with humans, and it ain’t human for anybody to give up two thousand dollars for that forty-pound chunk of freckled wildcat. I’m willing to take a chance at fifteen hundred dollars. You can charge the difference up to me.”

So, to relieve Bill, I acceded, and we collaborated a letter that ran this way:

Ebenezer Dorset, Esq.:

We have your boy concealed in a place far from Summit. It is useless for you or the most skilful detectives to attempt to find him. Absolutely, the only terms on which you can have him restored to you are these: We demand fifteen hundred dollars in large bills for his return; the money to be left at midnight tonight at the

same spot and in the same box as your reply—as hereinafter described. If you agree to these terms, send your answer in writing by a solitary messenger tonight at half-past eight o'clock. After crossing Owl Creek, on the road to Poplar Cove, there are three large trees about a hundred yards apart, close to the fence of the wheat field on the right-hand side. At the bottom of the fence-post, opposite the third tree, will be found a small pasteboard box.

The messenger will place the answer in this box and return immediately to Summit.

If you attempt any treachery or fail to comply with our demand as stated, you will never see your boy again.

If you pay the money as demanded, he will be returned to you safe and well within three hours. These terms are final, and if you do not accede to them no further communication will be attempted.

TWO DESPERATE MEN.

I addressed this letter to Dorset, and put it in my pocket.

As I was about to start, the kid comes up to me and says: “Aw, Snake-eye, you said I could play the Black Scout while you was gone.”

“Play it, of course,” says I. “Mr. Bill will play with you.

What kind of a game is it?”

“I’m the Black Scout,” says Red Chief, “and I have to ride to the stockade to warn the settlers that the Indians are coming. I’m tired of playing Indian myself. I want to be the Black Scout.”

“All right,” says I. “It sounds harmless to me. I guess Mr. Bill will help you foil the pesky savages.”

“What am I to do?” asks Bill, looking at the kid suspiciously.

“You are the hoss,” says Black Scout. “Get down on your hands and knees. How can I ride to the stockade without a hoss?”

“You’d better keep him interested,” said I, “till we get the scheme going. Loosen up.”

Bill gets down on his all fours, and a look comes in his eye like a rabbit's when you catch it in a trap.

"How far is it to the stockade, kid?" he asks, in a husky manner of voice.

"Ninety miles," says the Black Scout. "And you have to hump yourself to get there on time. Whoa, now!"

The Black Scout jumps on Bill's back and digs his heels in his side.

"For Heaven's sake," says Bill, "hurry back, Sam, as soon as you can. I wish we hadn't made the ransom more than a thousand. Say, you quit kicking me or I'll get up and warm you good.

I walked over to Poplar Cove and sat around the post office and store, talking with the chawbacons that came in to trade. One whiskerando says that he hears Summit is all upset on account of Elder Ebenezer Dorset's boy having been lost or stolen. That was all I wanted to know. I bought some smoking tobacco, referred casually to the price of black-eyed peas, posted my letter surreptitiously and came away. The postmaster said the mail carrier would come by in an hour to take the mail on to Summit.

When I got back to the cave Bill and the boy were not to be found. I explored the vicinity of the cave, and risked a yodel or two, but there was no response.

So I lighted my pipe and sat down on a mossy bank to await developments.

In about half an hour I heard the bushes rustle, and Bill wobbled out into the little glade in front of the cave. Behind him was the kid, stepping softly like a scout, with a broad grin on his face. Bill stopped, took off his hat and wiped his face with a red handkerchief. The kid stopped about eight feet behind him.

"Sam," says Bill, "I suppose you'll think I'm a renegade, but I couldn't help it. I'm a grown person with masculine proclivities and habits of self-defense, but there is a time when all systems of egotism and predominance fail. The boy is gone. I have sent him home. All is off. There was martyrs in old times," goes on Bill, "that suffered death rather than give up the particular graft they enjoyed. None of 'em ever was subjugated to such supernatural tortures as I have been. I tried to be faithful to our articles of depredation; but there came a limit."

"What's the trouble, Bill?" I asks him.

“I was rode,” says Bill, “the ninety miles to the stockade, not barring an inch. Then, when the settlers was rescued, I was given oats. Sand ain’t a palatable substitute. And then, for an hour I had to try to explain to him why there was nothin’ in holes, how a road can run both ways and what makes the grass green. I tell you, Sam, a human can only stand so much. I takes him by the neck of his clothes and drags him down the mountain. On the way he kicks my legs black-and-blue from the knees down; and I’ve got to have two or three bites on my thumb and hand cauterized.

“But he’s gone”—continues Bill— “gone home. I showed him the road to Summit and kicked him about eight feet nearer there at one kick. I’m sorry we lose the ransom; but it was either that or Bill Driscoll to the madhouse.”

Bill is puffing and blowing, but there is a look of ineffable peace and growing content on his rose-pink features.

“Bill,” says I, “there isn’t any heart disease in your family, is there?”

“No,” says Bill, “nothing chronic except malaria and accidents. Why?”

“Then you might turn around,” says I, “and have a look behind you.”

Bill turns and sees the boy, and loses his complexion and sits down plump on the ground and begins to pluck aimlessly at grass and little sticks. For an hour I was afraid for his mind. And then I told him that my scheme was to put the whole job through immediately and that we would get the ransom and be off with it by midnight if old Dorset fell in with our proposition. So Bill braced up enough to give the kid a weak sort of a smile and a promise to play the Russian in a Japanese war with him as soon as he felt a little better.

I had a scheme for collecting that ransom without danger of being caught by counterplots that ought to commend itself to professional kidnappers. The tree under which the answer was to be left—and the money later on—was close to the road fence with big, bare fields on all sides. If a gang of constables should be watching for anyone to come for the note, they could see him a long way off crossing the fields or in the road. But no, sirree! At half-past eight I was up in that tree as well hidden as a tree toad, waiting for the messenger to arrive.

Exactly on time, a half-grown boy rides up the road on a bicycle, locates the pasteboard box at the foot of the fence- post, slips a folded piece of paper into it and pedals away again back toward Summit.

I waited an hour and then concluded the thing was square. I slid down the tree, got the note, slipped along the fence till I struck the woods, and was back at the cave in another half an hour. I opened the note, got near the lantern and read it to Bill. It was written with a pen in a crabbed hand, and the sum and substance of it was this:

Two Desperate Men.

Gentlemen: I received your letter today by post, in regard to the ransom you ask for the return of my son. I think you are a little high in your demands, and I hereby make you a counter-proposition, which I am inclined to believe you will accept. You bring Johnny home and pay me two hundred and fifty dollars in cash, and I agree to take him off your hands. You had better come at night, for the neighbours believe he is lost, and I couldn't be responsible for what they would do to anybody they saw bringing him back.

Very respectfully,

EBENEZER DORSET.

“Great pirates of Penzance!” says I; “of all the impudent—”

But I glanced at Bill, and hesitated. He had the most appealing look in his eyes I ever saw on the face of a dumb or a talking brute.

“Sam,” says he, “what’s two hundred and fifty dollars, after all? We’ve got the money. One more night of this kid will send me to a bed in Bedlam. Besides being a thorough gentleman, I think Mr. Dorset is a spendthrift for making us such a liberal offer. You ain’t going to let the chance go, are you?”

“Tell you the truth, Bill,” says I, “this little he ewe lamb has somewhat got on my nerves too. We’ll take him home, pay the ransom and make our get-away.”

We took him home that night. We got him to go by telling him that his father had bought a silver-mounted rifle and a pair of moccasins for him, and we were going to hunt bears the next day.

It was just twelve o’clock when we knocked at Ebenezer’s front door. Just at the moment when I should have been abstracting the fifteen hundred dollars from the box under the tree, according to the original proposition, Bill was counting out two hundred and fifty dollars into Dorset’s hand.

When the kid found out we were going to leave him at home he started up a howl like a calliope and fastened himself as tight as a leech to Bill's leg. His father peeled him away gradually, like a porous plaster.

"How long can you hold him?" asks Bill.

"I'm not as strong as I used to be," says old Dorset, "but I think I can promise you ten minutes."

"Enough," says Bill. "In ten minutes I shall cross the Central, Southern and Middle Western States, and be legging it trippingly for the Canadian border."

And, as dark as it was, and as fat as Bill was, and as good a runner as I am, he was a good mile and a half out of Summit before I could catch up with him.

ΩΩΩ

Jabberwocky

Lewis Carroll

'Twas brillig, and the slithy toves
Did gyre and gimble in the wabe:
All mimsy were the borogoves,
And the mome raths outgrabe.

“Beware the Jabberwock, my son!
The jaws that bite, the claws that catch!
Beware the Jubjub bird, and shun
The frumious Bandersnatch!”

He took his vorpal sword in hand;
Long time the manxome foe he sought—
So rested he by the Tumtum tree
And stood awhile in thought.

And, as in uffish thought he stood,
The Jabberwock, with eyes of flame,
Came whiffling through the tulgey wood,
And burbled as it came!

One, two! One, two! And through and through
The vorpal blade went snicker-snack!
He left it dead, and with its head
He went galumphing back.

“And hast thou slain the Jabberwock?
Come to my arms, my beamish boy!
O frabjous day! Callooh! Callay!”
He chortled in his joy.

'Twas brillig, and the slithy toves
Did gyre and gimble in the wabe:
All mimsy were the borogoves,
And the mome raths outgrabe.

ΩΩΩ

The Sandbox (One-Act Play)

Edward Albee

A Brief Play, in Memory of My Grandmother (1876-1959)

PLAYERS

THE YOUNG MAN, 25, a good-looking, well-built boy in a bathing suit

MOMMY, 55, a well-dressed, imposing woman

DADDY, 60, a small man; gray, thin

GRANDMA, 86, a tiny, wizened woman with bright eyes

THE MUSICIAN, no particular age, but young would be nice

NOTE. *When, in the course of the play, MOMMY and DADDY call each other by these names, there should be no suggestion of regionalism. These names are of empty affection and point up the pre-senility and vacuity of their characters.*

THE SCENE. *A bare stage, with only the following: Near the footlights, far stage right, two simple chairs set side by side, facing the audience; near the footlights, far stage left, a chair facing stage right with a music stand before it; farther back, and stage center, slightly elevated and raked, a large child's sandbox with a toy pail and shovel; the background is the key, which alters from brightest day to deepest night.*

At the beginning, it is brightest day; the Young Man is alone on stage to the rear of the sandbox, and to one side. He is doing calisthenics; he does calisthenics until quite at the very end of the play. These calisthenics, employing the arms only, should suggest the beating and fluttering of wings. The Young Man is, after all, the Angel of Death.

MOMMY and DADDY enter from stage left, MOMMY first.

MOMMY (*motioning to DADDY*): Well, here we are; this is the beach.

DADDY (*whining*): I'm cold.

MOMMY (*dismissing him with a little laugh*): Don't be silly; it's as warm as toast. Look at that nice young man over there: he doesn't think it's cold (*waves to the YOUNG MAN*) Hello.

YOUNG MAN (*with an endearing smile*): Hi!

MOMMY (*looking about*): This will do perfectly...don't you think so, DADDY? There's sand there...and the water beyond. What do you think, DADDY?

DADDY (*vaguely*): Whatever you say, Mommy.

MOMMY (*with a little laugh*): Well, of course...whatever I say, Then, it's settled, is it?

DADDY (*shrugs*): She's your mother, not mine.

MOMMY: I know she's my mother. What do you take me for? (*a pause*) All right, now; let's get on with it. (*She shouts into the wings, stage-left*) You! Out there! You can come in now (*THE MUSICIAN enters, seats himself in the chair, stage-left, places music on the music stand, is ready to play. MOMMY nods approvingly.*) Very nice; very nice. Are you ready, Daddy? Let's go get Grandma.

DADDY Whatever you say, MOMMY.

MOMMY (*leading the way out, stage-left*): Of course, whatever I say. (*To the MUSICIAN*) You can begin now. (*THE MUSICIAN begins playing; MOMMY and DADDY exit; THE MUSICIAN, all the while playing, nods to THE YOUNG MAN.*)

YOUNG MAN (*with the same endearing smile*): Hi! (*After a moment, MOMMY and DADDY re-enter, carrying GRANDMA. She is borne in by their hands under her armpits; she is quite rigid; her legs are drawn up; her feet do not touch the ground; the expression on her ancient face is that of puzzlement and fear.*)

DADDY: Where do we put her?

MOMMY: *(the same little laugh)* Wherever I say, of course. Let me see...well...all right, over there...in the sandbox. *(Pause)* Well, what are you waiting for, Daddy? ... The sandbox! *(Together they carry GRANDMA over to the sandbox and more or less dump her in.)*

GRANDMA *(righting herself to a sitting position; her voice a cross between a baby's laugh and cry)*: Ahhhhhh! Graaaaaa!

DADDY: What do we do now?

MOMMY: *(to the MUSICIAN)*: You can stop now. *(THE MUSICIAN stops.)* *(Back to DADDY)* What do you mean, what do we do now? We go over there and sit down, of course. *(To THE YOUNG MAN)* Hello there.

YOUNG MAN *(smiling)*: Hi! *(MOMMY and DADDY move to the chairs, stage-right, and sitdown. A pause.)*

GRANDMA *(same as before)*: Ahhhhhh! Ah-haaaaaaa! Graaaaaa!

DADDY: Do you think...do you think she's...comfortable?

MOMMY *(impatiently)*: How would I know?

DADDY *(pause)*: What do we do now?

MOMMY: We...wait. We...sit here...and we wait...that's what we do.

DADDY *(after a pause)*: Shall we talk to each other?

MOMMY *(with that little laugh; picking something off her dress)* Well, you can talk, if you want to...if you can think of anything to say...if you can think of anything new.

DADDY *(thinks)*: No...I suppose not.

MOMMY *(with a triumphant laugh)*: Of course not!

GRANDMA (*banging the toy shovel against the pail*): Haaaaa! Ah-haaaaaa!

MOMMY (*out over the audience*): Be quiet, Grandma...just be quiet, and wait. (GRANDMA *throws a shovelful of sand at MOMMY. Still out over the audience*) She's throwing sand at me! You stop that, Grandma; you stop throwing sand at Mommy! (To DADDY) She's throwing sand at me. (DADDY *looks around at GRANDMA, who screams at him.*)

GRANDMA: GRAAAAAAA!

MOMMY: Don't look at her. Just ...sit here...be very still...and wait. (*To the MUSICIAN*)

You...uh...you can go ahead and do whatever it is you do (THE MUSICIAN *plays. MOMMY and DADDY are fixed, staring out beyond the audience. GRANDMA looks at them, looks at the MUSICIAN looks at the sandbox, throws down the shovel.*)

GRANDMA: Ah-haaaaaa! Graaaaaaa! (*Looks for reaction; gets none. Now...she speaks directly to the audience*) Honestly! What a way to treat an old woman! Drag her out of the house...stick her in a car.... bring her out here from the city.... dump her in a pile of sand...and leave her here to set. I'm eighty-six years old! I was married when I was seventeen. To a farmer. He died when I was thirty. (*To the MUSICIAN*) Will you stop that, please? (*The MUSICIAN stops playing*). I'm a feeble old woman...how do you expect anybody to hear me over that peep! peep! peep! (*To herself*) There's no respect around here. (*To the YOUNG MAN*) There's no respect around here!

YOUNG MAN (smiles) Hi!

GRANDMA (*after a pause, a mild double-take, continues, to the audience*) My husband died when I was thirty (*indicates MOMMY*), and I had to raise that big cow over there all by my lonesome. You can imagine what **that** was like. Lordy! (*To the Young Man*) Where'd they get **you**?

YOUNG MAN: Oh...I've been around for a while.

GRANDMA: I'll bet you have! Heh, heh, heh. Will you look at you!

YOUNG MAN (flexing his muscles): Isn't that something? (Continues his calisthenics)

GRANDMA: Boy, oh boy; I'll say. Pretty good.

YOUNG MAN (*sweetly*): I'll say.

GRANDMA: Where ya from?

YOUNG MAN: Southern California.

GRANDMA (*nodding*): Figgers; figgers. What's your name, honey?

YOUNG MAN: I don't know...

GRANDMA (*to the audience*): Bright, too!

YOUNG MAN: I mean...I mean, they haven't given me one yet...the studio...

GRANDMA (*giving him the once-over*): You don't say...you don't say. Well...uh, I've got to talk some more...don't you go 'way.

YOUNG MAN: Oh, no.

GRANDMA (*turning her attention to the audience*): Fine; fine. (*Then back once more to the YOUNG MAN*) You're...you're an actor, huh?

YOUNG MAN (*beaming*): Yes, I am.

GRANDMA (*to the audience again*): I'm smart that way. Anyhow, I had to raise ... *that* over there all by my lonesome, and what's next to her there...that's what she married. Rich? I tell you...money, money, money. They took me off the farm...which was real decent of them...and they moved me into the big townhouse with *them*...fixed a nice place for me under the stove...gave me an army

blanket...and my own dish...my very own dish! So, what have I got to complain about? Nothing, of course! I'm not complaining. (*She looks up at the sky, shouts to someone off stage*) Shouldn't it be getting dark now, dear? (*The lights dim; night comes on. The MUSICIAN begins to play; it becomes deepest night. There are spotlights on all the players, including the YOUNG MAN, who is, of course, continuing his calisthenics.*)

DADDY: It's nighttime.

MOMMY: Shhhhh. Be still...wait.

DADDY: (whining) It's so hot.

MOMMY: Shhhhhhh. Be still.... wait.

GRANDMA (*to herself*): That's better. Night. (*To the MUSICIAN*) Honey, do you play all through this part? (*The MUSICIAN nods*). Well, keep it nice and soft; that's a good boy. (*The MUSICIAN nods again; plays softly.*) That's nice. (*There is an off-stage rumble.*)

DADDY (*starting*): What was that?

MOMMY (*beginning to weep*): It was nothing.

DADDY: It was....it was...thunder...or a wave breaking...or something.

MOMMY (*whispering, through her tears*): It was an off-stage rumble... and you know what **that** means...

DADDY: I forget...

MOMMY (*barely able to talk*): It means the time has come for poor Grandma ... and I can't bear it!

DADDY: (*vacantly*): I...I suppose you've got to be brave.

GRANDMA (*mocking*): That's right, kid; be brave. You'll bear up; you'll get over it. (*Another off-stage rumble...louder*)

MOMMY: Ohhhhhhhhhhh...poor Grandma... poor Grandma ...

GRANDMA (*to MOMMY*): I'm fine! I'm all right! It hasn't happened yet! (*a*

violent off-stage rumble, all lights go out, save the spot on the YOUNG MAN; the MUSICIAN stops playing)

MOMMY: Ohhhhhhhh. . . Ohhhhhhhhhhhh..... *(Silence)*

GRANDMA: Don't put the lights up yet...I'm not ready; I'm not quite ready. *(Silence)* Allright, dear...I'm about done. *(The lights come up again, to the brightest day; the MUSICIAN begins to play. GRANDMA is discovered, still in the sandbox, lying on her side, propped up on an elbow, half covered, busily shoveling sand over herself.)*

GRANDMA *(muttering)* I don't know how I'm supposed to do anything with this god-damn toy shovel...

DADDY: Mommy! It's daylight!

MOMMY *(brightly)*: So it is! Well! Our long night is over. We must put away our tears, take off our mourning...and face the future. It's our duty.

GRANDMA *(still shoveling; mimicking)*: ...take off our mourning...face the future.... Lordy! *(MOMMY and DADDY rise, stretch. MOMMY waves to the YOUNG MAN.)*

YOUNG MAN *(with a smile)*: Hi! *(GRANDMA plays dead. [!] MOMMY and DADDY go over to look at her; she is little more than half-buried in the sand; the toy shovel is in her hands which are crossed on her breast.)*

MOMMY *(before the sandbox; shaking her head)* Lovely! It's.... it's hard to be sad...she looks...so happy. *(With pride and conviction)* It pays to do things well. *(To the MUSICIAN)* All right, you can stop now, if you want to. I mean, stay around for a swim, or something; it's all right with us. *(She sighs heavily)* Well, Daddy...off we go.

DADDY: Brave MOMMY!

MOMMY: Brave DADDY! *(They exit, stage-left)*

GRANDMA: *(after they leave; lying quite still)*. It pays to do things well...Boy, oh boy! *(She tries to sit up)* ... well, kids...*(but she finds she can't)*... I ...I can't get up. I ... I can't move... *(The YOUNG MAN stops his calisthenics, nods to the MUSICIAN, walks over to GRANDMA, kneels down by the sandbox.)*

GRANDMA: I.... can't move....

YOUNG MAN: Shhhh...be very still....

GRANDMA: I ... I can't move...

YOUNG MAN: Uh...ma'am; I...I have a line here.

GRANDMA: Oh, I'm sorry, sweetie; you go right ahead.

YOUNG MAN: I am ...uh...

GRANDMA: Take your time, dear.

YOUNG MAN: (*prepares; delivers the line like a real amateur*) . I am the Angel of Death. I am...uh...I am come for you.

GRANDMA: What...wha (*then, with resignation*) ...ohhhhh.... ohhhhh, I see. (*The YOUNG MAN bends over, kisses GRANDMA gently on the forehead.*)

GRANDMA (*her eyes closed, her hands folded on her breast again, the shovel between her hands, a sweet smile on her face*): Well.... that was very nice, dear...

YOUNG MAN (*still kneeling*): Shhhhh...be still....

GRANDMA: What I meant was...you did that very well, dear...

YOUNG MAN (*blushing*): ...oh...

GRANDMA No; I mean it. You've got that.... you've got a quality.

YOUNG MAN: (*with an endearing smile*) Oh...thank you; thank you very much...ma'am.

GRANDMA (*slowly; softly—as the YOUNG MAN puts his hands on top of GRANDMA's*): You're.... you're welcome.... dear.

(*Tableau: The MUSICIAN continues to play as the curtain comes down.*)

ΩΩΩ

I am an Ordinary Man (From My Fair Lady)

Alan Jay Lerner

Well after all, Pickering, I'm an ordinary man,
Who desires nothing more than an ordinary chance,
to live exactly as he likes, and do precisely what he wants...
An average man am I, of no eccentric whim,
Who likes to live his life, free of strife,
doing whatever he thinks is best, for him,
Well... just an ordinary man...
BUT, Let a woman in your life and your serenity is through,
she'll redecorate your home, from the cellar to the dome,
and then go on to the enthralling fun of overhauling you...
Let a woman in your life, and you're up against a wall,
make a plan and you will find,
that she has something else in mind,
and so rather than do either you do something else
that neither likes at all You want to talk of Keats and Milton,
she only wants to talk of love,
You go to see a play or ballet, and spend it searching
for her glove, Let a woman in your life
and you invite eternal strife,
Let them buy their wedding bands for those anxious little hands...

I'd be equally as willing for a dentist to be drilling
than to ever let a woman in my life, I'm a very gentle man,
even tempered and good natured
who you never hear complain,
Who has the milk of human kindness
by the quart in every vein,
A patient man am I, down to my fingertips,
the sort who never could, ever would,
let an insulting remark escape his lips
Very gentle man...
But, Let a woman in your life,
and patience hasn't got a chance,
she will beg you for advice, your reply will be concise,
and she will listen very nicely, and then go out
and do exactly what she wants!!!
You are a man of grace and polish,
who never spoke above a hush,
all at once you're using language that would make
a sailor blush, Let a woman in your life,
and you're plunging in a knife,
Let the others of my sex, tie the knot around their necks,
I prefer a new edition of the Spanish Inquisition
than to ever let a woman in my life I'm a quiet living man,
who prefers to spend the evening in the silence of his room,

who likes an atmosphere as restful as
an undiscovered tomb,

A pensive man am I, of philosophical joys,
who likes to meditate, contemplate,
far for humanities mad inhuman noise,
Quiet living man...

But, let a woman in your life, and your sabbatical is through,
in a line that never ends comes an army of her friends,
come to jabber and to chatter
and to tell her what the matter is with YOU!,
she'll have a booming boisterous family,
who will descend on you en mass,
she'll have a large Wagnerian mother,
with a voice that shatters glass,
Let a woman in your life,
Let a woman in your life,
Let a woman in your life I shall never let a woman in my life.

ΩΩΩ

The Value of Science

Richard Feynman

When I was younger, I thought science would make good things for everybody. It was obviously useful; it was good. During the war I worked on the atomic bomb. This result of science was obviously a very serious matter: it represented the destruction of people. After the war I was very worried about the bomb. I didn't know what the future was going to look like, and I certainly wasn't anywhere near sure that we would last until now. Therefore one question was—is there some evil involved in science? Put another way—what is the value of the science I had dedicated myself to—the thing I loved—when I saw what terrible things it could do? It was a question I had to answer. “The Value of Science” is a kind of report, if you will, on many of the thoughts that came to me when I tried to answer that question.—Richard Feynman

From time-to-time people suggest to me that scientists ought to give more consideration to social problems—especially that they should be more responsible in considering the impact of science on society. It seems to be generally believed that if the scientists would only look at these very difficult social problems and not spend so much time fooling with less vital scientific ones, great success would come of it.

It seems to me that we do think about these problems from time to time, but we don't put a full-time effort into them—the reasons being that we know we don't have any magic formula for solving social problems, that social problems are very much harder than scientific ones, and that we usually don't get anywhere when we do think about them.

I believe that a scientist looking at non-scientific problems is just as dumb as the next guy—and when he talks about a non-scientific matter, he sounds as naive as anyone untrained in the matter. Since the question of the value of science is not a scientific subject, this talk is dedicated to proving my point—by example.

The first way in which science is of value is familiar to everyone. It is that scientific knowledge enables us to do all kinds of things and to make all kinds of things. Of course if we make good things, it is not only to the credit of

science; it is also to the credit of the moral choice which led us to good work. Scientific knowledge is an enabling power to do either good or bad - but it does not carry instructions on how to use it. Such power has evident value - even though the power may be negated by what one does with it.

I learned a way of expressing this common human problem on a trip to Honolulu. In a Buddhist temple there, the man in charge explained a little bit about the Buddhist religion for tourists, and then ended his talk by telling them he had something to say to them that they would never forget—and I have never forgotten it. It was a proverb of the Buddhist religion: To every man is given the key to the gates of heaven; the same key opens the gates of hell.

What then, is the value of the key to heaven? It is true that if we lack clear instructions that enable us to determine which is the gate to heaven and which the gate to hell, the key may be a dangerous object to use.

But the key obviously has value: how can we enter heaven without it?

Instructions would be of no value without the key. So it is evident that, in spite of the fact that it could produce enormous horror in the world, science is of value because it can produce something.

Another value of science is the fun called intellectual enjoyment which some people get from reading and learning and thinking about it, and which others get from working in it. This is an important point, one which is not considered enough by those who tell us it is our social responsibility to reflect on the impact of science on society.

Is this mere personal enjoyment of value to society as a whole? No! But it is also a responsibility to consider the aim of society itself. Is it to arrange matters so that people can enjoy things? If so, then the enjoyment of science is as important as anything else.

But I would like not to underestimate the value of the world view which is the result of scientific effort. We have been led to imagine all sorts of things infinitely more marvellous than the imaginings of poets and dreamers of the past. It shows that the imagination of nature is far, far greater than the imagination of man. For instance, how much more remarkable it is for us all to be stuck—half of us upside down—by a mysterious attraction to a spinning ball that has been swinging in space for billions of years than to be carried on the back of an elephant supported on a tortoise swimming in a bottomless sea.

I have thought about these things so many times alone that I hope you will excuse me if I remind you of this type of thought that I am sure many of you have had, which no one could ever have had in the past because people then didn't have the information, we have about the world today. For instance, I stand at the seashore, alone, and start to think.

There are the rushing waves mountains of molecules each stupidly minding its own businesstrillions apart.....yet forming white surf in unison.

Ages on ages.... before any eyes could see.... year after year..... thunderously pounding the shore as now..... For whom, for what?..... On a dead planet with no life to entertain.

Never at rest.....tortured by energy.....wasted prodigiously by the sun poured into space. A mite makes the sea roar.

Deep in the sea, all molecules repeat the patterns of one another till complex new ones are formed. They make others like themselvesand a new dance starts.

Growing in size and complexity...living things masses of atoms DNA, protein dancing a pattern ever more intricate.

Out of the cradle onto dry land here it is standing: atoms with consciousness; matter with curiosity.

Stands at the sea, wonders at wondering: I a universe of atoms, an atom in the universe.

The same thrill, the same awe and mystery, comes again and again when we look at any question deeply enough. With more knowledge comes a deeper, more wonderful mystery, luring one on to penetrate deeper still. Never concerned that the answer may prove disappointing, with pleasure and confidence we turn over each new stone to find unimagined strangeness leading on to more wonderful questions and mysteries—certainly a grand adventure!

It is true that few unscientific people have this particular type of religious experience. Our poets do not write about it; our artists do not try to portray this remarkable thing. I don't know why. Is no one inspired by our present picture of the universe? This value of science remains unsung by singers: you are reduced

to hearing not a song or poem, but an evening lecture about it. This is not yet a scientific age.

Perhaps one of the reasons for this silence is that you have to know how to read the music. For instance, the scientific article may say, “The radioactive phosphorus content of the cerebrum of the rat decreases to one-half in a period of two weeks.” Now what does that mean?

It means that phosphorus that is in the brain of a rat - and also in mine, and yours—is not the same phosphorus as it was two weeks ago. It means the atoms that are in the brain are being replaced: the ones that were there before have gone away.

So, what is this mind of ours: what are these atoms with consciousness? Last week's potatoes! They now can remember what was going on in my mind a year ago—a mind which has long ago been replaced.

To note that the thing I call my individuality is only a pattern or dance, that is what it means when one discovers how long it takes for the atoms of the brain to be replaced by other atoms. The atoms come into my brain, dance a dance, and then go out - there are always new atoms, but always doing the same dance, remembering what the dance was yesterday.

When we read about this in the newspaper, it says “Scientists say this discovery may have importance in the search for a cure for cancer.” The paper is only interested in the use of the idea, not the idea itself. Hardly anyone can understand the importance of an idea, it is so remarkable. Except that, possibly, some children catch on. And when a child catches on to an idea like that, we have a scientist. It is late—although not too late - for them to get the spirit when they are in our universities, so we must attempt to explain these ideas to children.

I would now like to turn to a third value that science has. It is a little less direct, but not much. The scientist has a lot of experience with ignorance and doubt and uncertainty, and this experience is of very great importance, I think. When a scientist doesn't know the answer to a problem, he is ignorant. When he has a hunch as to what the result is, he is uncertain. And when he is pretty darn sure of what the result is going to be, he is still in some doubt. We have found it of paramount importance that in order to progress we must recognize our ignorance and leave room for doubt. Scientific knowledge is a body of

statements of varying degrees of certainty—some most unsure, some nearly sure, but none absolutely certain.

Now, we scientists are used to this, and we take it for granted that it is perfectly consistent to be unsure, that it is possible to live and not know. But I don't know whether everyone realizes this is true. Our freedom to doubt was born out of a struggle against authority in the early days of science. It was a very deep and strong struggle: permit us to question—to doubt—to not be sure. I think that it is important that we do not forget this struggle and thus perhaps lose what we have gained. Herein lays a responsibility to society.

We are all sad when we think of the wondrous potentialities human beings seem to have, as contrasted with their small accomplishments. Again and again people have thought that we could do much better. Those of the past saw in the nightmare of their times a dream for the future. We, of their future, see that their dreams, in certain ways surpassed, have in many ways remained dreams. The hopes for the future today are, in good shape, those of yesterday.

It was once thought that the possibilities people had were not developed because most of the people were ignorant. With universal education, could all men be Voltaire's? Bad can be taught at least as efficiently as good. Education is a strong force, but for either good or evil.

Communications between nations must promote understanding—so went another dream. But the machines of communication can be manipulated. What is communicated can be truth or lie. Communication is a strong force, but also for either good or evil.

The applied sciences should free men of material problems at least. Medicine controls diseases. And the record here seems all to the good. Yet there are some patiently working today to create great plagues and poisons for use in warfare tomorrow.

Nearly everyone dislikes war. Our dream today is peace. In peace, man can develop best the enormous possibilities he seems to have. But maybe future men will find that peace, too, can be good and bad. Perhaps peaceful men will drink out of boredom. Then perhaps drink will become the great problem which seems to keep man from getting all he thinks he should out of his abilities.

Clearly, peace is a great force—as are sobriety, material power, communication, education, honesty, and the ideals of many dreamers. We have

more of these forces to control than did the ancients. And maybe we are doing a little better than most of them could do. But what we ought to be able to do seem gigantic compared with our confused accomplishments.

Why is this? Why can't we conquer ourselves? Because we find that even great forces and abilities do not seem to carry with them clear instructions on how to use them. As an example, the great accumulation of understanding as to how the physical world behaves only convinces one that this behaviour seems to have a kind of meaninglessness. The sciences do not directly teach good and bad.

Through all ages of our past, people have tried to fathom the meaning of life. They have realized that if some direction or meaning could be given to our actions, great human forces would be unleashed. So, very many answers have been given to the question of the meaning of it all. But the answers have been of all different sorts, and the proponents of one answer have looked with horror at the actions of the believers in another—horror, because from a disagreeing point of view all the great potentialities of the race are channelled into a false and confining blind alley. In fact, it is from the history of the enormous monstrosities created by false belief that philosophers have realized the apparently infinite and wondrous capacities of human beings. The dream is to find the open channel.

What, then, is the meaning of it all? What can we say to dispel the mystery of existence?

If we take everything into account—not only what the ancients knew, but all of what we know today that they didn't know—then I think we must frankly admit that we do not know.

But, in admitting this, we have probably found the open channel.

This is not a new idea; this is the idea of the age of reason. This is the philosophy that guided the men who made the democracy that we live under. The idea that no one really knew how to run a government led to the idea that we should arrange a system by which new ideas could be developed, tried out, and tossed out if necessary, with more new ideas brought in—a trial-and-error system. This method was a result of the fact that science was already showing itself to be a successful venture at the end of the eighteenth century. Even then it was clear to socially minded people that the openness of possibilities was an

opportunity, and that doubt and discussion were essential to progress into the unknown. If we want to solve a problem that we have never solved before, we must leave the door to the unknown ajar.

We are at the very beginning of time for the human race. It is not unreasonable that we grapple with problems. But there are tens of thousands of years in the future. Our responsibility is to do what we can, learn what we can, improve the solutions, and pass them on. It is our responsibility to leave the people of the future a free hand. In the impetuous youth of humanity, we can make grave errors that can stunt our growth for a long time. This we will do if we say we have the answers now, as young and ignorant as we are. If we suppress all discussion, all criticism, proclaiming “This is the answer, my friends; man is saved!” we will doom humanity for a long time to the chains of authority, confined to the limits of our present imagination. It has been done so many times before.

It is our responsibility as scientists, knowing the great progress which comes from a satisfactory philosophy of ignorance, the great progress which is the fruit of freedom of thought, to proclaim the value of this freedom; to teach how doubt is not to be feared but welcomed and discussed, and to demand this freedom as our duty to all coming generations.

ΩΩΩ

Hawk Roosting

Ted Hughes

I sit in the top of the wood, my eyes closed.

Inaction, no falsifying dream

Between my hooked head and hooked feet:

Or in sleep rehearse perfect kills and eat.

The convenience of the high trees!

The air's buoyancy and the sun's ray

Are of advantage to me;

And the earth's face upward for my inspection

My feet are locked upon the rough bark.

It took the whole of Creation

To produce my foot, my each feather:

Now I hold Creation in my foot

Or fly up, and revolve it all slowly -

I kill where I please because it is all mine

There is no sophistry in my body:

My manners are tearing off heads –

The allotment of death
For the one path of my flight is direct
Through the bones of the living
No arguments assert my right:

The sun is behind me.
Nothing has changed since I began.
My eye has permitted no change.
I am going to keep things like this.

ΩΩΩ

The Kabuliwallah

Rabindranath Tagore

My five years' old daughter Mini cannot live without chattering. I really believe that in all her life she has not wasted a minute in silence. Her mother is often vexed at this, and would stop her prattle, but I would not. To see Mini quiet is unnatural, and I cannot bear it long. And so my own talk with her is always lively.

One morning, for instance, when I was in the midst of the seventeenth chapter of my new novel, my little Mini stole into the room, and putting her hand into mine, said: "Father! Ramdayal the door-keeper calls a crow a krow! He doesn't know anything, does he?"

Before I could explain to her the differences of language in this world, she was embarked on the full tide of another subject. "What do you think, Father? Bhola says there is an elephant in the clouds, blowing water out of his trunk, and that is why it rains!"

And then, darting off anew, while I sat still making ready some reply to this last saying: "Father! what relation is Mother to you?"

With a grave face I contrived to say: "Go and play with Bhola, Mini! I am busy!"

The window of my room overlooks the road. The child had seated herself at my feet near my table, and was playing softly, drumming on her knees. I was hard at work on my seventeenth chapter, where Pratap Singh, the hero, had just caught Kanchanlata, the heroine, in his arms, and was about to escape with her by the third-story window of the castle, when all of a sudden Mini left her play, and ran to the window, crying: "A Kabuliwallah! a Kabuliwallah!" Sure enough in the street below was a Kabuliwallah, passing slowly along. He wore the loose, soiled clothing of his people, with a tall turban; there was a bag on his back, and he carried boxes of grapes in his hand.

I cannot tell what were my daughter's feelings at the sight of this man, but she began to call him loudly. "Ah!" I thought, "he will come in, and my seventeenth chapter will never be finished!" At which exact moment the Kabuliwallah turned, and looked up at the child. When she saw this, overcome by terror, she fled to her mother's protection and disappeared. She had a blind belief that inside the bag, which the big man carried, there were perhaps two or three other children like herself. The pedlar meanwhile entered my doorway and greeted me with a smiling face.

So precarious was the position of my hero and my heroine, that my first impulse was to stop and buy something, since the man had been called. I made some small purchases, and a conversation began about Abdurrahman, the Russians, the English, and the Frontier Policy.

As he was about to leave, he asked: "And where is the little girl, sir?"

And I, thinking that Mini must get rid of her false fear, had her brought out.

She stood by my chair, and looked at the Kabuliwallah and his bag. He offered her nuts and raisins, but she would not be tempted, and only clung the closer to me, with all her doubts increased.

This was their first meeting.

One morning, however, not many days later, as I was leaving the house, I was startled to find Mini, seated on a bench near the door, laughing and talking, with the great Kabuliwallah at her feet. In all her life, it appeared, my small daughter had never found so patient a listener, save her father. And already the corner of her little sari was stuffed with almonds and raisins, the gift of her visitor. "Why did you give her those?" I said, and taking out an eight-anna bit, I handed it to him. The man accepted the money without demur, and slipped it into his pocket.

Alas, on my return an hour later, I found the unfortunate coin had made twice its own worth of trouble! For the Kabuliwallah had given it to Mini; and her mother, catching sight of the bright round object, had pounced on the child with: "Where did you get that eight-anna bit?"

"The Kabuliwallah gave it me," said Mini cheerfully.

"The Kabuliwallah gave it you!" cried her mother much shocked. "O Mini! how could you take it from him?"

I, entering at the moment, saved her from impending disaster, and proceeded to make my own inquiries.

It was not the first or second time, I found, that the two had met. The Kabuliwallah had overcome the child's first terror by a judicious bribery of nuts and almonds, and the two were now great friends.

They had many quaint jokes, which afforded them much amusement. Seated in front of him, looking down on his gigantic frame in all her tiny dignity, Mini would ripple her face with laughter and begin: "O Kabuliwallah! Kabuliwallah! what have you got in your bag?"

And he would reply, in the nasal accents of the mountaineer: "An elephant!" Not much cause for merriment, perhaps; but how they both enjoyed the fun! And for me, this child's talk with a grown-up man had always in it something strangely fascinating.

Then the Kabuliwallah, not to be behindhand, would take his turn: "Well, little one, and when are you going to the father-in-law's house?"

Now most small Bengali maidens have heard long ago about the father-in-law's house; but we, being a little new-fangled, had kept these things from our child, and Mini at this question must have been a trifle bewildered. But she would not show it, and with ready tact replied: "Are you going there?"

Amongst men of the Kabuliwallah's class, however, it is well known that the words father-in-law's house have a double meaning. It is a euphemism for jail, the place where we are well cared for, at no expense to ourselves. In this sense would the sturdy pedlar take my daughter's question. "Ah," he would say, shaking his fist at an invisible policeman, "I will thrash my father-in-law!" Hearing this, and picturing the poor discomfited relative, Mini would go off into peals of laughter, in which her formidable friend would join.

These were autumn mornings, the very time of year when kings of old went forth to conquest; and I, never stirring from my little corner in Calcutta, would let my mind wander over the whole world. At the very name of another country, my heart would go out to it, and at the sight of a foreigner in the streets, I would fall to weaving a network of dreams,—the mountains, the glens,

and the forests of his distant home, with his cottage in its setting, and the free and independent life of faraway wilds. Perhaps the scenes of travel conjure themselves up before me and pass and repass in my imagination all the more vividly, because I lead such a vegetable existence that a call to travel would fall upon me like a thunder-bolt. In the presence of this Kabuliwallah I was immediately transported to the foot of arid mountain peaks, with narrow little defiles twisting in and out amongst their towering heights. I could see the string of camels bearing the merchandise, and the company of turbanned merchants carrying some their queer old firearms, and some their spears, journeying downward towards the plains. I could see-- But at some such point Mini's mother would intervene, imploring me to "beware of that man."

Mini's mother is unfortunately a very timid lady. Whenever she hears a noise in the street, or sees people coming towards the house, she always jumps to the conclusion that they are either thieves, or drunkards, or snakes, or tigers, or malaria, or cockroaches, or caterpillars. Even after all these years of experience, she is not able to overcome her terror. So, she was full of doubts about the Kabuliwallah, and used to beg me to keep a watchful eye on him.

I tried to laugh her fear gently away, but then she would turn round on me seriously, and ask me solemn questions: --

Were children never kidnapped?

Was it, then, not true that there was slavery in Cabul?

Was it so very absurd that this big man should be able to carry off a tiny child?

I urged that, though not impossible, it was highly improbable. But this was not enough, and her dread persisted. As it was indefinite, however, it did not seem right to forbid the man the house, and the intimacy went on unchecked.

Once a year in the middle of January Rahmun, the Kabuliwallah, was in the habit of returning to his country, and as the time approached, he would be very busy, going from house to house collecting his debts. This year, however, he could always find time to come and see Mini. It would have seemed to an outsider that there was some conspiracy between the two, for when he could not come in the morning, he would appear in the evening.

Even to me it was a little startling now and then, in the corner of a dark room, suddenly to surprise this tall, loose-garmented, much bebagged man; but when Mini would run in smiling, with her "O Kabuliwallah! Kabuliwallah!" and the two friends, so far apart in age, would subside into their old laughter and their old jokes, I felt reassured.

One morning, a few days before he had made up his mind to go, I was correcting my proof sheets in my study. It was chilly weather. Through the window the rays of the sun touched my feet, and the slight warmth was very welcome. It was almost eight o'clock, and the early pedestrians were returning home with their heads covered. All at once I heard an uproar in the street, and, looking out, saw Rahmun being led away bound between two policemen, and behind them a crowd of curious boys. There were blood-stains on the clothes of the Kabuliwallah, and one of the policemen carried a knife. Hurrying out, I stopped them, and inquired what it all meant. Partly from one, partly from another, I gathered that a certain neighbour had owed the pedlar something for a Rampuri shawl, but had falsely denied having bought it, and that in the course of the quarrel Rahmun had struck him. Now, in the heat of his excitement, the prisoner began calling his enemy all sorts of names, when suddenly in a verandah of my house appeared my little Mini, with her usual exclamation: "O Kabuliwallah! Kabuliwallah!" Rahmun's face lighted up as he turned to her. He had no bag under his arm to-day, so she could not discuss the elephant with him. She at once therefore proceeded to the next question: "Are you going to the father-in-law's house?" Rahmun laughed and said: "Just where I am going, little one!" Then, seeing that the reply did not amuse the child, he held up his fettered hands. "Ah!" he said, "I would have thrashed that old father-in-law, but my hands are bound!"

On a charge of murderous assault, Rahmun was sentenced to some years' imprisonment.

Time passed away and he was not remembered. The accustomed work in the accustomed place was ours, and the thought of the once-free mountaineer spending his years in prison seldom or never occurred to us. Even my light-hearted Mini, I am ashamed to say, forgot her old friend. New companions filled her life. As she grew older, she spent more of her time with girls. So much time indeed did she spend with them that she came no more, as she used to do, to her father's room. I was scarcely on speaking terms with her.

Years had passed away. It was once more autumn and we had made arrangements for our Mini's marriage. It was to take place during the Puja Holidays. With Durga returning to Kailas, the light of our home also was to depart to her husband's house, and leave her father's in the shadow.

The morning was bright. After the rains, there was a sense of ablution in the air, and the sun-rays looked like pure gold. So bright were they, that they gave a beautiful radiance even to the sordid brick walls of our Calcutta lanes. Since early dawn that day the wedding-pipes had been sounding, and at each beat my own heart throbbed. The wail of the tune, Bhairavi, seemed to intensify my pain at the approaching separation. My Mini was to be married that night.

From early morning noise and bustle had pervaded the house. In the courtyard the canopy had to be slung on its bamboo poles; the chandeliers with their tinkling sound must be hung in each room and verandah. There was no end of hurry and excitement. I was sitting in my study, looking through the accounts, when someone entered, saluting respectfully, and stood before me. It was Rahmun the Kabuliwallah. At first, I did not recognise him. He had no bag, nor the long hair, nor the same vigour that he used to have. But he smiled, and I knew him again.

"When did you come, Rahmun?" I asked him.

"Last evening," he said, "I was released from jail."

The words struck harsh upon my ears. I had never before talked with one who had wounded his fellow, and my heart shrank within itself when I realised this; for I felt that the day would have been better omened had he not turned up.

"There are ceremonies going on," I said, "and I am busy. Could you perhaps come another day?"

At once he turned to go; but as he reached the door he hesitated, and said: "May I not see the little one, sir, for a moment?" It was his belief that Mini was still the same. He had pictured her running to him as she used, calling "O Kabuliwallah! Kabuliwallah!" He had imagined too that they would laugh and talk together, just as of old. In fact, in memory of former days he had brought, carefully wrapped up in paper, a few almonds and raisins and grapes, obtained somehow from a countryman; for his own little fund was dispersed.

I said again: "There is a ceremony in the house, and you will not be able to see any one to-day."

The man's face fell. He looked wistfully at me for a moment, then said "Good morning," and went out.

I felt a little sorry, and would have called him back, but I found he was returning of his own accord. He came close up to me holding out his offerings with the words: "I brought these few things, sir, for the little one. Will you give them to her?"

I took them and was going to pay him, but he caught my hand and said: "You are very kind, sir! Keep me in your recollection. Do not offer me money!-You have a little girl: I too have one like her in my own home. I think of her, and bring fruits to your child--not to make a profit for myself."

Saying this, he put his hand inside his big loose robe, and brought out a small and dirty piece of paper. With great care he unfolded this, and smoothed it out with both hands on my table. It bore the impression of a little hand. Not a photograph. Not a drawing. The impression of an ink-smeared hand laid flat on the paper. This touch of his own little daughter had been always on his heart, as he had come year after year to Calcutta to sell his wares in the streets.

Tears came to my eyes. I forgot that he was a poor Cabuli fruit-seller, while I was--. But no, what was I more than he? He also was a father.

That impression of the hand of his little Pārbati in her distant mountain home reminded me of my own little Mini.

I sent for Mini immediately from the inner apartment. Many difficulties were raised, but I would not listen. Clad in the red silk of her wedding-day, with the sandal paste on her forehead, and adorned as a young bride, Mini came, and stood bashfully before me.

The Kabuliwallah looked a little staggered at the apparition. He could not revive their old friendship. At last he smiled and said: "Little one, are you going to your father-in-law's house?"

But Mini now understood the meaning of the word "father-in-law," and she could not reply to him as of old. She flushed up at the question, and stood before him with her bride-like face turned down.

I remembered the day when the Kabuliwallah and my Mini had first met, and I felt sad. When she had gone, Rahmun heaved a deep sigh, and sat down on the floor. The idea had suddenly come to him that his daughter too must have grown in this long time, and that he would have to make friends with her anew. Assuredly he would not find her as he used to know her. And besides, what might not have happened to her in these eight years?

The marriage-pipes sounded, and the mild autumn sun streamed round us. But Rahmun sat in the little Calcutta Lane, and saw before him the barren mountains of Afghanistan.

I took out a bank-note and gave it to him, saying: "Go back to your own daughter, Rahmun, in your own country, and may the happiness of your meeting bring good fortune to my child!"

Having made this present, I had to curtail some of the festivities. I could not have the electric lights I had intended, nor the military band, and the ladies of the house were despondent at it. But to me the wedding-feast was all the brighter for the thought that in a distant land a long-lost father met again with his only child.

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Remedial Grammar

Parts of Speech

Words are divided into different kinds or classes according to their use. These kinds or classes are known as 'Parts of Speech'. They are eight in number:

1. Noun
2. Pronoun
3. Verb
4. Adjective
5. Adverb
6. Preposition
7. Conjunction
8. Interjection

Noun: A noun is a word used to name a person, animal, place, thing, and abstract idea; as,

- The **teacher** told the **children** to stop chattering in **class**.
- **John** is good at **French** but weak at **History**.

The highlighted words in the above sentences are all nouns.

There are various different subcategories of nouns such as the **proper noun**, the **collective noun**, the **possessive noun** and the **common noun**. Each one of these serves a different purpose.

Pronoun: A pronoun can replace a noun or another pronoun. We use pronouns like "he," "which," "none," and "you" to make your sentences less cumbersome and less repetitive.

Pronouns can be classified into several types, including the personal pronoun, the demonstrative pronoun, the interrogative pronoun, the indefinite pronoun, the relative pronoun, the reflexive pronoun, and the intensive pronoun.

Pronoun example sentences:

- a. Richard isn't at work this week; **he's** gone on holiday.
- b. Don't tell **her** the truth.
- c. She tried it **herself**.
- d. **You** can't blame **him** for everything.
- e. The woman **who** called yesterday wants to buy the house.

Verb: The verb is the most important part of the sentence. A verb asserts something about the subject of the sentence and express actions, events, or states of being; as,

- Dracula bites his victims on the neck.
- The man walked down the street.
- I laughed at his joke.

Adjective: An adjective modifies a noun or a pronoun by describing, identifying, or quantifying words. An adjective usually precedes the noun or the pronoun which it modifies; as,

- This is a **blue** car.
- The **small** squirrel ran up the tree.
- During the thunderstorm, we saw some **heavy** rain.
- My mother has **short** hair.
- The documentary on TV last night was very **interesting**.

Comparison of Adjectives:

Three forms of comparison of adjectives:

- Positive: it is an ordinary form of adjectives; as,
Rama's mango is **sweet**.
 - Comparative: shows when two persons or objects being compared; as,
Karan's mango is sweeter than Rama's.
 - Superlative: indicates that the quality or quantity is at its highest or is most intense; as,
Gaurav's mango is the sweetest of all.
-

Adverb: An adverb is a word which modifies a verb, an adjective, another adverb, a phrase, or a clause. An adverb indicates manner, time, place, cause, or degree and answers questions such as "how," "when," "where," "how much"; as,

- This is an **extremely** attractive photograph.
- I have a **very** interesting book.
- My car drives **quickly**.
- When I am running late for work, I eat my breakfast **rapidly**.

Preposition: A preposition is used to show a relationship between two words or phrases; such as,

in, before, on, at, into, between, in front of etc.

- The cat is sitting **on** the wall.
- I am going to the salon **after** my dinner.
- You will find the theatre **in** the town centre.
- I saw that news **in** the newspapers.

Conjunction: We use a conjunction to link words, phrases, and clauses; as,

- I ate the pizza **and** the pasta.
- Call the movers **when** you are ready.

There are three types of conjunctions:

1. **Co-ordinating Conjunction:** We use a co-ordinating conjunction ("and," "but," "or," "nor," "for," "so," or "yet") to join individual words, phrases, and independent clauses; as,
Lilacs and violets are usually purple.
2. **Subordinating Conjunction:** A subordinating conjunction introduces a dependent clause and indicates the nature of the relationship among the independent clause(s) and the dependent clause(s); as,
After she had learned to drive, John felt more independent.
3. **Correlative Conjunctions:** Correlative conjunctions always appear in pairs – we use them to link equivalent sentence elements. The most common correlative conjunctions are "both...and," "either...or,"

"neither...nor," "not only...but also," "so...as," and "whether...or."
(Technically correlative conjunctions consist simply of a co-ordinating conjunction linked to an adjective or adverb) ; as,

Both my grandfather and my father worked in the steel plant.

Interjection: An interjection is a word which expresses some sudden feeling or emotion. They are used to emotion, reaction or excitement and have no grammatical link to anything else within the sentence they appear; as,

- Hurrah! We have won the game.
- Alas! He is dead.
- Oh! I got such a fright.

Articles

An article is an adjective. Like adjectives, articles modify nouns. English has two articles: **the** and **a/an**.

A /An is called the Indefinite Article, because it used to modify non-specific or non-particular nouns.

- A doctor; that is, any doctor.
- Let's read a book. It can be any book.

The is called the Definite Article, because it points out some particular person or thing; as,

"Let's read the book," (It can be particular book.)

Indefinite Articles: 'a' and 'an':

We use a/an depends on the sound that begins the next word. We use **an** before noun beginning with vowel sound; as,

an enemy, an ink-pad, an orange, an umbrella, an hour , an heir, an honest man

We can notice that the words 'hour', 'heir', 'honest' begin with a vowel sound, as the initial consonant *h* is not pronounced.

We use '**a**' before noun beginning with a consonant sound; as,

a boy, a woman, a horse, a yard,

a university, a union, a unicorn, a European,

We can notice that the words ‘University’, ‘Union’, ‘European’ begin with consonant sound that of ‘yu’.

In the same way we say, ‘a one-rupee note’, ‘a one-eyed man’. We use ‘a’ before ‘one’, because ‘one’ begins with consonant sound ‘w’.

Definite Article: ‘the’:

We use Definite article ‘the’ in these conditions:

- ‘The’ is used before singular and plural nouns when the noun is specific or particular or one already referred to; as,
 - The dog that bit me ran away." Here, we're talking about a specific dog, the dog that bit me.
 - The book you want is out of print. Here, we are talking about a specific book.
- We use ‘the’ when a singular noun is meant to represent a whole class; as,
 - The horse is a noble animal.
 - The cat loves comfort.
 - The rose is the sweetest of all flowers.
- We use ‘the’ before some proper names. These kinds of places-names:
 - a. Oceans and seas; as, the Pacific, the Black Sea
 - b. Rivers; as, the Ganga, the Nile
 - c. Points on the globe: the Equator, the North Pole
 - d. Geographical areas: the Middle East, the West
 - e. Deserts, forests, gulfs, and peninsulas: the Sahara, the Persian Gulf, the Black Forest, the Iberian Peninsula
- We use ‘the’ before the names of certain books; as,
the Vedas, the Ramayana, the Iliad etc.
- We use ‘the’ with Superlatives; as,
The darkest cloud has a silver lining.

This is the best book.

Omission of the Articles:

Article is omitted in these conditions:

- Before names of the substances and abstract nouns used in general sense; as,
Sugar is not good for teeth.
Gold is precious metal.
- Before plural countable nouns used in general sense; as,
Children like candies.
Computers are useful.
- Many languages and nationalities are not preceded by an article; as,
I studied French in high school for four years.
- Sports and academic subjects do not require articles; as,
I like to play basketball.
My sister was always good at math.

Exercise:

Fill up the blanks with a/an, the, or no articles:

1. Moving to_____United States was_____most exciting thing I have ever done.
 2. I moved last year to_____New York.
 3. New York is_____exciting city, full of adventure.
 4. In fact, I saw_____famous actor on_____street yesterday!
 5. Today, I have_____job interview at_____financial company.
 6. _____has offices all over_____world.
 7. I'm not sure that I have_____skills to get hired. I hope so.
 8. Company's office is on_____Main Street. That's_____same street my friend works on.
 9. If I get hired, I could meet him after_____work for drinks. That would be great.
 10. He's from_____Scotland. He works 8 hours_____day,_____5 days week.
-

Punctuation

In speaking, we use pauses and the pitch of the voice to make what we say clear. Punctuation plays a similar role in writing, making it easier to read. The most common punctuation marks in English are:

1. **Full Stop or Period (.)**
2. **Capital Letters (A C J H)**
3. **Commas (,)**
4. **Semicolon (;)**
5. **Colon (:)**
6. **Question Mark (?)**
7. **Exclamation Mark (!)**

Other punctuation marks in common use are the Dash (-), Parentheses (), Inverted commas or Quotation Marks “ ”.

Full Stop or Period (.) :

Use a period at the end of a complete sentence that is a statement. Example: I know him well.

The period can be used in abbreviations.

Example: Mr Brown

U.N.O.

M.P.

Capital Letters: We use capital letters to mark the beginning of a sentence and we use full stops to mark the end of a sentence:

Example:

- We went to France last summer.
- We were really surprised that it was so easy to travel on the motorways.

We also use capital letters at the beginning of proper nouns. Proper nouns include personal names (including titles before names), nationalities and languages, days of the week and months of the year, public holidays as well as geographical places:

Example:

- Dr David James is the consultant at Leeds City Hospital.
- They are planning a long holiday in New Zealand.
- Can she speak Japanese?
- The next meeting of the group will take place on Thursday.
- What plans do you have for Chinese New Year?

We use capital letters for the titles of books, magazines and newspapers, plays and music:

Example:

- ‘Oliver’ is a musical based on the novel ‘Oliver Twist’ by Charles Dickens.
- The Straits Times is a daily English language newspaper in Singapore.
- They are performing Beethoven’s Sixth Symphony.

Commas: A comma is often used to separate different ideas in a sentence. However, it has many other uses as well, and it is important to remember them as well. Some of the most common comma rules follow:

- We use commas to separate a list of similar words or phrases:

Example: It’s important to write in clear, simple, accurate words.

- We use commas to separate each pair of words connected by *and* :

Example: We should be devout and humble, cheerful and serene.

- A comma is used after an introductory word or phrase,

Example: I can’t tell you now. However, all will be revealed tomorrow at midday.

- If we have a tag question at the end of the sentence, we also need to use a comma to distinguish it from the rest of the sentence.

Example: You are going to the party this weekend, aren’t you?

Semicolon (;) We use semi-colons instead of full stops to separate two main clauses. In such cases, the clauses are related in meaning but are separated grammatically:

Example:

- Spanish is spoken throughout South America; in Brazil the main language is Portuguese.
- My mother is a doctor; my father is an accountant.

Colon (:) We commonly use a colon between sentences when the second sentence explains or justifies the first sentence:

Example:

Try to keep your flat clean and tidy: it will sell more easily.

We use colons to introduce lists:

Example: There are three main reasons for the success of the government: economic, social and political.

Question mark (?): The Question Mark is used, instead of the Period, after a direct question.

Example:

- How old are you?
- Why do they make so many mistakes?

Exclamation Mark (!): An exclamation mark added at the end of a sentence shows emphasis. Depending on the meaning of the sentence, it can indicate anger, happiness, excitement, or any other strong emotion.

Example:

- Leave me alone!
- I'm so happy to see you!

- What a terrible fire this is!

Dash (-): The dash is used to indicate an abrupt stop or change of thought. Example:

Just wanted to thank you for a lovely evening – we really enjoyed it.

We use dash to resume a scattered subject.

Example: Friends, companions, relatives-all deserted him.

Parentheses (): Parentheses are used to separate from the main part of the sentence a phrase or clause which does not grammatically belong to it.

Example: He gained from Heaven (it was all he wished) a friend.

Inverted commas Quotation Marks (“”): Quotation marks are used to enclose the exact words of a speaker, or a quotation.

Example:

- “You’ll never believe what happened last night,” Jerry said.
- She said, “Where can we find a nice Indian restaurant?”

Exercise

Use appropriate punctuation marks in the following sentences.

1. We had a great time in France the kids really enjoyed it
2. Some people work best in the mornings others do better in the evenings
3. What are you doing next weekend
4. Mother had to go into hospital she had heart problems

5. Did you understand why I was upset
6. It is a fine idea let us hope that it is going to work
7. We will be arriving on Monday morning at least I think so
8. A textbook can be a wall between teacher and class
9. The girls father sat in a corner
10. In the words of Murphy' Law Anything that can go wrong will go wrong

Question Tags

A tag question is a special construction in English. It is a statement followed by a mini-question. We use tag questions to ask for confirmation. They mean something like: "Is that right?" or "Do you agree?" They are very common in English.

The basic structure of a tag question is:

Positive Statement	Negative Tag
Reena broke the glass,	didn't she?

Negative Statement	Positive Tag
Rohan doesn't work,	does he?

Some more examples:

It's raining, isn't it?
 You are free, aren't you?
 You aren't busy, are you?
 She can't swim, can she?

Note: The subject of the question tag is always a pronoun, not noun.

Some verbs/expressions have different question tags. For example:

Some verbs/expressions have different question tags. For example:

I am - I am attractive, aren't I?

Positive imperative - Stop daydreaming, will / won't you?

Negative imperative - Don't stop singing, will you?

Let's - Let's go to the beach, shall we?

Short Answer:

How do we answer a tag question? Often, we just say Yes or No. Sometimes we may repeat the tag and reverse it (They don't live here, do they? Yes, they do). We can use these formulas:

Yes + Pronoun + Auxiliary

Or

No + Pronoun + Auxiliary + n't (not)

Example:

Are you going to school? Yes, I am. Or No, I am not.

Is your daughter married? Yes, she is. Or No, she isn't.

Exercise:

Complete the sentences with the correct question tags.

1. Mr Guinness is from Ireland, isn't he?
2. The car isn't in the garage, _____?
3. You are John, _____?

4. She went to the library yesterday, _____?
5. He didn't recognize me, _____?
6. Cars pollute the environment, _____?
7. Mr Pritchard has been to Scotland recently, _____?
8. The trip is very expensive, _____?
9. He won't tell her, _____?
10. Hugh had a red car, _____?

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Types of Sentences

A sentence is nothing but set of words that is complete in itself, typically containing a subject and predicate, conveying a statement, question, exclamation or command and consisting of a main clause and sometimes one or more subordinate clauses.

On basis of the function of the sentence they can be broadly classified into 5 types:

- I. Declarative/Assertive sentence
 - II. Affirmative sentence
 - III. Interrogative sentence
 - IV. Imperative sentence
 - V. Exclamatory sentence
-

Declarative/Assertive sentence:

These kinds of sentences are basically used to state information or declare something. They are the most common type of sentence used in any language. Declarative sentences can be positive or negative. The sentence always ends with a period.

- I'm feeling hungry
 - He goes to college near the park.
 - They are singing my favourite song.
-

Affirmative sentence:

These sentences are used to describe any general action, event, speech or expression.

- All students are present in class.
 - I am never late.
 - She is reading a book I recommended.
-

Interrogative sentence:

These sentences are used in order to ask a question. Interrogative sentences end with question marks. In English, interrogative questions often begin with interrogative words like who, when, where, why, what, and how.

- Who asked you to leave the group?
- When did this happen?
- Where are you going?
- Why would you say something like that to him?
- What does this mean?
- How have you been holding up?
-

A question fragment can be added onto the end of a declarative or imperative sentence. This fragment is called a tag/tail question.

- You have answered all the questions on this test, haven't you? (After a declarative sentence)
 - Close the window, will you? (After an imperative sentence)
-

Imperative sentence:

These sentences are used to give a command, make a request. They can also be used to express sentences which suggest giving an advice, a suggestion, a warning, or a wish. They can be followed by a period, a question mark, or an exclamation mark.

- Be quiet. (Command)
 - Please have a seat. (Request)
 - Watch out! (Warning)
 - You could apply for the exam as you have time now. (Advice)
 - Enjoy yourselves. (Suggestion)
-

Exclamatory sentence:

These sentences are used to express great exclaim, or show strong emotion. Exclamatory sentences end with exclamation marks. Use of exclamatory phrases is also common in these sentences.

- That magic trick was amazing!
- What wonderful weather we are having today!
- How lovely to see you!
- How well he sings!
- Hurrah! We won the match

Exercise:

Identify the type of sentences given below:

1. They are reading a book.
2. Do you speak English?
3. It's a fine day!
4. She is not a student.
5. I do not like rainy weather.
6. She never walks alone.
7. Where do you live?
8. Stand up.
9. Open the door, will you?
10. How wonderful! What fine weather we are having today.

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Transformation and Synthesis of Sentences

A sentence is a grammatically complete idea. The parts of the sentence are a set of terms for describing how people construct sentences from smaller pieces. All sentences have a noun or pronoun component called the subject, and a verb part called the predicate. The subject is what (or whom) the sentence is about, while the predicate tells something about the subject.

In order to understand transformation of sentences we first need to understand the basics such as what the parts that sentences are made up of such as clauses and conjunctions.

What is a Clause?

A clause is comprised of a group of words which includes a subject and a predicate; however, is not a complete sentence in itself. A clause contains only one subject and one verb. The subject of a clause can be mentioned or hidden, but the verb must be apparent and distinguishable.

Clauses are divided into two types: independent and dependent clause.

Independent Clause:

An independent clause contains both a subject and a predicate. It can stand alone as a sentence or can be a part of a multi-clause sentence. Two or more independent clause is used in compound sentences.

Examples:

- I like him.
- Can you do it?
- Do it please

- I read the whole story.
 - Alex smiles whenever he sees her.
 - I want to buy a phone, but I don't have enough money. (Two independent clauses)
 - He went to London and visited the Lords. (Two independent clauses)
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Dependent Clause:

A dependent clause cannot function on its own because it leaves an idea or thought unfinished. It is also called subordinate clause. Dependent clauses help the independent clauses complete the sentence. A dependent clause alone cannot form a complete sentence.

The subordinators do the work of connecting the dependent clause to another clause to complete the sentence. In each of the dependent clause, the first word is a subordinator. Subordinators include relative pronouns, subordinating conjunctions, and noun clause markers.

Examples:

- When I was dating Derek, I had an accident.
 - I know the woman who stole the watch.
 - She bought a car which was too expensive.
 - I know that he cannot do it.
 - She does not know where she was born.
 - If you don't eat, I won't go.
 - She is a very talented player though she is out of form.
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What are Conjunctions?

Conjunctions are basically words which are used to join clauses, phrases, and words together to construct sentences. They are usually used in order to make a link between words or phrases to other parts of the sentence and show a relationship among them. Conjunctions are classified into three types: coordinating, correlative and subordinating conjunctions.

Coordinating conjunctions:

A coordinating conjunction is used to join two words, phrases, or independent clauses, which are parallel in structure. There are seven coordinating conjunctions which are by far the most used: for, and, nor, but, or, yet and so.

(**FANBOYS* is a simple mnemonic that can be used to recall coordinating conjunctions)

- We went to the stadium and enjoyed the cricket match.
 - Do you want an ice cream or chocolate?
 - She hates the water yet likes the beach.
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Correlative conjunctions:

Correlative conjunction uses a set of words in a parallel sentence structure to show a contrast or to compare the equal parts of a sentence. The words of correlative conjunctions have a special connection between them.

The correlative conjunctions are not only - but also, either- or, neither - nor, both - and, not - but, whether - or.

- Neither Alex nor Robin can play baseball.
 - I want both ice cream and
 - He ate not only the ice cream but also the chocolate.
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Subordinating conjunctions:

A subordinating conjunction joins elements of an unparallelled sentence structure. These elements are usually a dependent clause and an independent clause.

Most commonly used subordinating conjunctions are: After, how, than, when, although, if, that, where, as, in order that, though, which, as much as, inasmuch as, unless, while, because, provided, until, who/whom, before, since, what, whoever/whomever.

- Before we left home, I had had my breakfast.
 - When he was washing my car, I went to the store.
 - Even though the weather was horrible, they still went outside.
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Transformation of Sentences:

There are essentially three types of sentences: simple, complex and compound sentences.

Simple Sentence:

A simple sentence is one clause with a subject and verb. However, it can have more than one subject and verb.

- Computers are important in the modern world. (SV)
 - Computers and other technological devices are important in the modernworld. (SSV)
 - I search for information and play games on my computer. (SVV)
 - My brother and I search for information and play games on our computers. (SSVV)
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Compound Sentence:

A compound sentence consists of 2 or 3 clauses. It is formed when simple sentences are joined together. In this type of sentence, the clauses are joined

using only coordinating conjunctions such as for, and, nor, but, or, yet and so. There is an instance when you can have a compound sentence structure without a coordinating conjunction, and this is when you join two clauses with a semicolon. It is used when two ideas are related.

- Mary doesn't like cartoons because they are loud, so she doesn't watch them.
 - I have often wanted to drown my troubles, but I can't get my wife to go swimming.
 - Dr Mark said I could come to his office on Friday or Saturday of next week.
 - Computers are used widely in most countries; they are a sign of progress.
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Complex Sentence:

Complex sentences have one clause and one or more subordinate clauses. In this type of sentence two or more clauses are joined together, by subordinating conjunctions.

The most commonly used subordinate conjunctions are: such as, after, although, as, as if, as long as, as much as, as soon as, as though, because, before, even if, even though, if, in order to, in case, once, since, so that, though, unless, until, when, whenever, whereas, where, wherever, while etc.

- People take natural health supplements even though they may not have been tested.
- Our children may not be properly educated if we don't spend more on schools.
- Even though they may not have been tested, people take natural health supplements.

- If we don't spend more on schools, our children may not be properly educated.
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Rules for Transformation of Sentences:

Listed below are 10 rules than help in the transformation of simple sentences to complex and vice versa.

1. “Present participle” in a simple sentence, to convert into complex sentences by adding “since/as/when” at the first half of the sentence.
 - Simple Sentence: Closing the door, I went back to the hospital.
 - Complex Sentence: When I closed the door, I went back to the hospital.
2. Being/ Verb + ing” in a simple sentence, to convert into a complex sentence by adding “as/when/since” at the first half of the sentence.
 - Simple Sentence: After winning the science fair he cried.
 - Complex Sentence: As he won the science fair, he cried.
3. “Too...to” in a simple sentence, to convert into a complex sentence by adding “so...that (negative)”.
- Simple Sentence: He is too weak to carry the drum.
 - Complex Sentence: He is so weak that he cannot carry the drum.
4. “To” in the simple sentence, to convert into a complex sentence by adding “so that” in the sentence.
 - Simple sentence: We eat to live.
 - Complex Sentence: We eat so that we can live.

5. In the simple sentence “in spite of/ despite”, to convert into the complex sentence by adding “though/ although” in the sentence.
- Simple Sentence: In spite of being rich, he is hard working.
 - Complex Sentence: Though he is rich, he is hard working.
6. “Because of” in the simple sentence, to convert it to the complex sentence by adding “since” at the beginning of the sentence.
- Simple Sentence: Because of his illness, he could not join the competition.
 - Complex Sentence: Since he was ill, he could not join the competition.
7. “Subject + verb + object + present participle” type of simple sentence, to convert it to the complex sentence by “subject + verb + object + relative pronoun of the object + be verb according to relative pronoun and tense + rest of the sentence”.
- Simple Sentence: I saw an eagle flying.
 - Complex Sentence: I saw an eagle which was flying.
8. In the simple sentence starts with “without”, by adding “if/ in case” is converted into the complex sentence.
- Simple Sentence: Without adding the sugar the muffins will taste bad.
 - Complex Sentence: If you do not add sugar the muffins will taste bad.
9. In the simple sentence “at the time” will be converted into “when” in the complex sentence.

- Simple Sentence: He woke up at the time of arrival.
- Complex Sentence: He woke up when it was arrival.

10. In the simple sentence, “adjective” will be converted into “that/which” in the complex sentence.

- Simple Sentence: It was a purple gown.
- Complex Sentence: It was a gown which was purple.

Exercise:

A. Transform the following sentences as instructed:

- I. She woke up when it was midnight (Change to Simple)
- II. I was so weak that I could not run (Change to Simple)
- III. He was too poor to educate his children (Change to Complex)
- IV. They ran away and thus escaped arrest (Change to Simple)
- V. Besides teaching us Math, Mr Philip also writes poetry (Change to Compound)
- VI. The old man being weak could not walk properly (Change to Compound)
- VII. I don't know the way which leads to her house (Change to Simple)
- VIII. She is innocent in this matter and I am confident about it (Change to Complex)
- IX. He cannot attend the wedding as he is in the hospital (Change to compound)
- X. The thieves ran away otherwise they would have been arrested (Change to Simple)

B. Transform the following sentences as instructed:

- I. You should respect your elders (Change to imperative sentence)
 - II. How remarkable the magic show was! (Change to assertive sentence)
 - III. It is extremely hot.(Change to exclamatory sentence)
 - IV. Students imitate their teachers. (Change to negative sentence)
 - V. He paid the fees later than usual.(Change to interrogative sentence)
 - VI. A doctor's life isn't easy.(Change to affirmative sentence)
 - VII. Please submit your assignments on time.(Change to imperative)
 - VIII. Bring me my wallet. (Change to interrogative sentence)
 - IX. Will you help me with the work given? (Change to exclamatory sentence)
 - X. Her brother is more generous in comparison.(Change to affirmative sentence)
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Synthesis of Sentences

Synthesis of sentences refers to the combination of a number of simple sentences to form a new sentence – the new sentence which is therefore formed could be simple, complex or compound.

Synthesis of sentences essentially works in three ways:

- Making a new simple sentence with two or more simple sentences.
- Making a new complex sentence with two or more simple sentences.
- Making a new compound sentence with two or more simple sentences.

Making a new simple sentence with two or more than two simple sentences:

There are six ways to make a new simple sentence by adding two or more than two simple sentences.

- I. By using Participle
- II. By using noun or phrase
- III. By using preposition

IV. By using nominative absolute

V. By using infinitive

VI. By using adverb or adjective

By using a participle:

- He saw a lion. He fled away.
Seeing a lion he fled away.
- She jumped up. She ran away.
Jumping up she ran away.
- She jumped up. She ran away.
Jumping up she ran away.

By using Noun or Phrase in Opposition:

- I love Lisa very much. She is my sister.
I love my sister Lisa very much.
- I saw a famous dancer. His name is Derek.
I saw the famous dancer, Derek.
- My friend was killed in a plane crash. He was one of my greatest supporters in my bad time.
My friend, one of my greatest supporters in my bad time, was killed in a plane crash.

By using Preposition with Noun or Gerund:

- We reached the movie hall. The movie had finished by that time.
Before our reaching the movie hall, the movie had finished.
- The servant swept the room; he found a rupee lying in the corner.
While sweeping the room, the servant found a rupee lying in a corner.
- He has failed many times. He still hopes to get success at last.
In spite of many failures he still hopes to get success at least.

By using Nominative Absolute:

- The office caught fire. All the furniture was brunt to ashes.
The office having caught fire, all the furniture was brunt to ashes.
- Rains have been plentiful this year. The crop of apple has been rich.
Rains having been plentiful this year, the crop of apple have been rich.
- The thieves were caught by the police. They surrendered the stolen property.
Having been caught by the police, the thieves surrender the stolen property.

By using Infinitive:

- I am going to Jaipur. I have to purchase a house.
I am going to Jaipur to purchase a house.
- There are still three questions left. I have to solve them.
I have still three more questions to solve.
- He is very weak. He cannot pass this year.
He is too weak to pass this year.

By using adverb or adjective:

- It was evening. The train had not reached by the time.
The train had not reached by evening.
 - This hall is large. Three hundred people can sit in it.
This hall is large enough for three hundred people to sit in.
 - She has much time. She can enjoy this big mall.
She has time enough to enjoy this big mall.
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Making a new complex sentence with two or more than two simple sentences:

There are three ways to make a new complex sentence by adding two or more than two simple sentences.

- i. By using a noun clause
 - ii. By using an adjective clause
 - iii. By using an adverb clause
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By using a noun clause:

- He is saint. Everybody knows it.
Everybody knows that he is a saint.
- I told you that yesterday. You should try it.
You must try that what I told you yesterday.
- He has failed. The reason is his illness.
The reason of his failure is that he is ill.
- He was innocent. This was her statement. It was right.
Her statement that he was innocent was right.

By using Adjective Clause:

- I met an old man. He was very weak.
I met an old man who was very weak.
- I saw a car. It was black in colour.
I saw a car which was black in colour.
- I met friend. His phone was stolen in the train.
I met your friend whose phone was stolen in the train.
- I have purchased a big house, it has a big guest rooms. My guestroom is well- decorated.

The house that I have purchased has a big guest room which is well decorated.

By using Adverb clause:

- I could not come. I was ill.
I could not come because I was tied.
 - He committed the theft. He has been caught by the police.
He committed the theft, so he has been caught by the police.
 - Tell me the truth. I shall pardon you.
I shall pardon you if you tell me the truth.
 - The thief saw the police. He took his heels.
 - As soon as the thief saw the police, he took his heels.
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Making a new compound sentence with two or more than two simple sentences:

Compound sentences can be made by adding two or more than two simple sentences while using either co-ordinate conjunctions or appropriate punctuation marks to connect them.

- I went to the market. I saw a beautiful watch. I could not, however purchase it.
I went to the market and saw a beautiful watch but I could not purchase it.
- He is slow. He is regular. He is slow but regular. He is industrious. He is very serious in his work.
He is not only industrious but also very serious in his work.
- Get in. You may catch cold.
Get in or you may catch cold.
- It was very cold last night. I could not have a sound sleep.
It was very cold last night and therefore I could not have a sound sleep.

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